

Listening

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Catching Up After Many Years

Before you listen

- What do old friends usually talk about when they meet after a long time?
- Predict two things the speakers might mention that had happened before they met again.

1. Why hadn't A and B seen each other?

- a. They had had an argument.
- b. They had lost contact since finishing university.
- c. They had moved to different countries permanently.
- d. They had never actually met before.

2. Before getting her current job, A had worked abroad for three years. — *True / False*

3. By the time she left, A had actually _____ a new language too.

4. What had B already started by the time he turned thirty?

- a. A new job
- b. A family
- c. His own small business
- d. A university course

A Grandmother's Story

Before you listen

- What kinds of stories do grandparents often tell about their own past?
- Listen for the order of events in the grandmother's life.

1. What had the grandmother already done by the age of eighteen?

- a. Got married
- b. Left her home town to study
- c. Started working as an engineer
- d. Had children

2. The grandmother had known the grandfather for many years before they married. — *True / False*

3. By the time they celebrated their first anniversary, they had already _____ three times.

4. According to the story, what had shaped the grandmother into a resilient person?

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- a. Her university studies
- b. All her different experiences moving to new cities
- c. Her career as an engineer
- d. Her time as a teacher